UNIT 2: NOUNS AND PRONOUNS

Nouns are the names of people, animals, plants, or abstract concepts. For example, drops of water from clouds → rain, a place where people gather to study → library, images that you experience during your sleep → dream – *rain*, *library*, and *dream* are nouns. In the TOEIC test, there are usually questions about the positions of nouns. Therefore, it is important to study their positions and some common ways to form them.

1 Positions and Functions of Nouns

1) As a subject

The subject comes before the verb and most often at the beginning of a sentence.

Example _____ of job performance usually takes place at the end of the week.

(A) Reviewed Tính t (B) Reviewer ườ (C) Review V, N

2) After an adjective

A noun often comes after an adjective and is modified by the adjective e.g. long *hair*, exciting *sports*.

Example The company received numerous _____ about the quality of products.

(A) complaining (B) complains (C) complaints

V

3) After a transitive verb

A noun functions as the object after a transitive verb e.g. verb *buy* + noun *shoes* = *buy shoes*.

have a passion + for

Example The company accepted _____ for those defective products.

(A) responsibility + for (B) responsible (C) response

N adj n

interest in

respond (v)

4) After an article

There are two types of articles: indefinite articles (*a*, *an*) and definite article (*the*). The indefinite article *a/an* is used before a singular countable noun and means *one*. The definite article *the* is used to make a general thing specific. For example, when you want to eat *one apple*, it can be *an apple* (any apple should do). When you want to eat *that juicy apple* but not any other one, that will be *the apple*.

Example The store on the first floor of the hotel sells a _____ of souvenirs.

(A) various (B) variety (C) vary v

adj N : su da dang

tinh tu so huu + N

dtnx -> ttsh
I -> my
you -> your, ...

5) After a possessive case

his book
tinh tu so huu

A possessive case indicates the meaning of ***belonging to*** or ***of***. Possessive adjectives include ***my***, ***your***, ***his***, ***her***, ***our***, ***their***, and ***its***. (Attention: ***it's*** is the reduced form of ***it is***). The possessive case of a noun may take the form of ***noun's***, e.g. ***Lori's***. Possessive adjectives cannot stand alone and must be followed by a noun, e.g. ***his house***.

Example Employees in the payroll department gave their _____ to the charity last week.

(A) donate (B) donations (C) donator

6) After a preposition gioi tu prep + N

in the morning
at school
by bus
in front of the house

Prepositions come before a noun or pronoun and express various notions such as time, place, condition, means, and direction e.g. ***in the room***, ***at 9 o'clock***, ***about him***. A noun that comes after a preposition remains unchanged in form, but a pronoun after a preposition must be in the objective case (***me***, ***you***, ***her***, ***him***, ***us***, ***them***, and ***it***).

Example We tried to handle the fragile items with _____ when they were delivered.

(A) cautious (B) caution (C) cautiously

adj adv

2 Common Noun Suffixes

-ion	evaluation	application
-ment	employment	payment
-ance	performance	maintenance
-ence	convenience	evidence
-ness	awareness	freshness
-cy	accuracy	emergency
-ity	security	productivity
-ive*	objective	alternative
-al*	arrival	approval

duoi al
thuong la tinh tu

* Although **-ive** and **-al** are often used as adjective suffixes, they can also be used as noun suffixes in some cases.

Practice 1:

S V prep

1 This manual provides _____ on how to operate your new microwave oven properly.

đúng cách van hanh

(A) instruct V
(B) instructor N
(C) instructions N
(D) instructional adj

2 Workers are required to wear _____ clothes while they are on the construction site.

are required : hien tai don bi dong

(A) protection
(B) protect
(C) protected tinh tu duoi ed chi hanh dong -> bi dong
(D) protective

3 It looks like that there is no considerable _____ between these two photocopiers.

A differs/differing from B: A khac voi B

(A) different
(B) differentiate V
(C) differing V
(D) difference

differentiate between A and B: phan biet A va B

4 Visitors should present a form of _____ when they wish to enter the building.

(A) identify
(B) identifying su khac nhau C va D (n)
(C) identification Chi giay to
(D) identity chi danh tinh, ban sac cua nguoi

5 I'm sorry to remind you that we haven't received any written _____ from the registration office.

(A) confirm
(B) confirming
(C) confirmation
(D) confirmed

2 menh de
menh de that

dung tính tu thuong the hien tinh chat
tinh tu duoi ed chi hanh dong

result (v): -> dan den
(n) : ket qua

6 The latest research _____ about the pollution levels will be published immediately.

tuong lai don bi dong

(A) resulting
(B) results
(C) resulted
(D) result in hien tai don

trong meh de chi chia thi 1 lan

7 _____ designed our new computer system to suit the needs of our company.

suit the needs: dap ung nhu cau

(A) Research Chi vat
(B) Researching cai viec ngien cuu
(C) Researched
(D) Researchers nguoi thiet ke

8 Because of bad weather _____, all flights to the Philippines were canceled yesterday afternoon.

(A) qualification tra nghia cau
(B) approval
(C) conditions
(D) analysis

9 A(n) _____ of experienced sales representatives can harm overall sales earnings.

(A) emphasis su nhan manh
(B) variety nhieu loai
(C) security su an toan cua
(D) lack lack of (n), su thieu

S1 S2

10 Those who will sign any contract are advised to review the terms of the _____.

those signing any contract ...

(A) production
(B) agreement
(C) consideration
(D) newsletter

term of the agreement: dieu khoan thoa thuan
term of the contract: dieu khoan hop dong

In general, a pronoun is used to replace a noun that was already mentioned. Therefore, it must agree with the noun it replaces in terms of number (singular – plural), grammatical gender (masculine – feminine), and case (subjective case – possessive case – objective case).

1 Basic Uses and Cases of Pronouns

1) Agreement between nouns and pronouns

Singular nouns are replaced by singular pronouns, and plural nouns by plural pronouns.

- **The corporation** announced yesterday that **it** decided to reduce costs.
- **The corporations** announced that **they** would retain **their names** after **they** are merged.

2) Pronoun cases

In the TOEIC test, some questions ask about the noun-pronoun agreement in the subjective case, possessive case (before a noun), and objective case (after a transitive verb or preposition).

Number	Person	Subjective case	Possessive case	Objective case	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive pronoun
Singular	1st person	I	my	me	mine	myself
	2nd person	you	your	you	yours	yourself
	3rd person	he she it	his her its	him her it	his hers	himself herself itself
Plural	1st person	we	our	us	ours	ourselves
	2nd person	you	your	you	yours	yourselves
	3rd person	they	their	them	theirs	themselves

❶ Subjective case – at the beginning of a sentence and before the verb

- If **your** should require more information, I'll send it to you immediately. (×)
  → If **you** should require more information, I'll send it to you immediately. (○)

- John and **me** will take care of all the invitations to the going-away party. (×)
  → John and **I** will take care of all the invitations to the going-away party. (○)

Tinh tu so huu

❷ Possessive case – used as an adjective, modifying the noun and indicating whom or which the noun belongs to

- Please submit **you** résumé and cover letter to the personnel department. (×)
  → Please submit **your** résumé and cover letter to the personnel department. (○)

Dai tu so huu: = tinh tu so huu + danh tu
Do đó: Dai tu so huu dung mot minh

※ Reference

Possessive pronoun = Possessive Case + Noun. Therefore, no noun is required after a possessive pronoun.

· That's mine umbrella. (×)

· That's my umbrella. → That's mine. (○)

❸ Objective case – after a transitive verb or preposition

Tan ngu: Dung sau dong tu hoac gioi tu

- Mr. Toma was determined to give **them** a pay increase last month.
- Some brochures were sent to **him and his associates** yesterday.

❹ Reflexive pronoun

Dai tu phan than

A reflexive pronoun is used when the subject in a sentence performs an action (which is described by the verb) on itself.

a. It is used as the object of a transitive verb or preposition when the subject and object refer to the same person(s) or thing(s).

- Help **yourself** to the food.

b. It can be used to emphasize the subject or object. A reflexive pronoun usually comes at the end of a sentence/clause or next to the noun it emphasizes.

- I fixed the copy machine **myself** and Lora made copies.
- The woman **herself** moved the furniture without any help.

c. Common use

by oneself = alone = on one's own

- I thought I could manage technical problems **by myself**.
- They are going to deal with the problem **by themselves**.

❺ Pronoun *it*

Pronoun *it* is used as the subject in sentences about the weather, distance, time, season, surroundings, etc. It does not have a specific meaning.

- It is raining heavily.
- It is 3 miles to the school.
- It is dark outside.
- It is Saturday today.

3) Pronoun redundancy

Khong can them dai tu chu ngu, neu cau da co chu ngu

A subjective pronoun is not required in a sentence which already has a subject.

- The tenants ~~they~~ must pay their rent on time. (×)

Practice 2:

chinh phu da khen ngoi thanh cong cua ho trong viec tai to chuc va cat giam

1 The president _____ checked the estimated sales figures for the next quarter.

(A) him sai: day la tan ngu

(B) he co the bo, vi da co chu ngu

(C) himself dai tu phan than -> khong phu hop

(D) his tinh tu so huu -> phai co danh tu di kem

2 We are going to experiment with _____ analysis on the symptoms of the influenza.

tien hanh thu nghiem

ve cac trieu chung cua benh cum

(A) she

(B) her

(C) hers

(D) herself

3 A notice should be forwarded to _____ bank as soon as possible.

(A) you

(B) your

(C) yours

(D) yourself

4 The president hopes that you will call _____ immediately to let him know about the results.

(A) himself

(B) he

(C) him

(D) his

5 I'm writing again to you on the recommendation of a colleague of _____.

(A) my

(B) mine

(C) I

(D) myself

6 The government praised _____ success in reorganizing and downsizing within a limited time. (n)

(A) them

(B) whose

(C) their

(D) those

7 Employees have to make copies of food receipts and turn _____ in to the accounting office.

(A) they

(B) their

(C) them

(D) themselves

8 As a result of a heavy workload, the payroll department had trouble finishing analysis by _____.

(A) it

(B) one

(C) itself

(D) oneself

9 Mr. Spencer devised innovative strategies and _____ proved to be useful.

(A) we

(B) you

(C) they

(D) it

10 You should fill out the forms and return them at _____ earliest convenience.

(A) you

(B) your

(C) yours

(D) yourself

Practice 3:

Questions 131-134 refer to the following e-mail.

To: Bai Chang <bchang@lexrg.com>
From: customerservice@sprtech.com
Date: September 28
Subject: Order 255646

Dear Ms. Chang:

Thank you for your purchase on September 27. Your package has shipped and is due to arrive on October 1. ------- **131.** . Simply visit www.sprtech.com/shipping/status, enter your order number, and press "Search."

When you receive your package, we ------- **132.** you to take a short survey at www.sprtech.com/survey. It is through customer feedback that we are ------- **133.** to monitor our level of service. Upon ------- **134.** of the survey, you will receive a 10% discount toward your next order.

Sprtech.com Customer Service

131. (A) You will receive a full refund.
(B) A replacement is on back order.
(C) Tracking your order is easy.
(D) We will answer your question soon.

132. (A) invited
(B) invite
(C) were inviting
(D) have invited

133. (A) able
(B) skillful
(C) suitable
(D) equal

134. (A) publication
(B) production
(C) introduction
(D) completion

Questions 135-138 refer to the following information.

Conference Room 120 can be booked for meetings and conference calls. First, make a reservation request online at www.gzpoffice.com/confroom. When your request ------- **135.**, the system automatically checks for availability. Your request will be accepted if no other event is scheduled at that time. The system will then immediately send you an e-mail message to ------- **136.** your reservation. However, if another meeting is scheduled that conflicts with yours, you will be notified that the request has been declined. ------- **137.**. It is therefore ------- **138.** that you schedule your event well ahead of time. This way, if a given time slot is already reserved, you will be able to reschedule your meeting.

135. (A) is received
(B) receiving
(C) to receive
(D) received

136. (A) move
(B) cancel
(C) change
(D) confirm

137. (A) Thank you for accepting our invitation to the event.
(B) Please prepare discussion points before the meeting.
(C) Note that reservations are on a first-come, first-served basis.
(D) The time of the next meeting will be announced in due course.

138. (A) fortunate
(B) advisable
(C) previous
(D) flexible

Questions 139-142 refer to the following e-mail.

From: Karel Authier <k.authier@codetouchmag.com>
To: Honorato Quinones <quinones@voyacon.com.es>
Date: Tuesday, July 18 11:04 A.M.
Subject: Voyacon Feature

Dear Mr. Quinones:

I am delighted to inform you that Voyacon has been selected as one of this year's *Code Touch Magazine*'s Top 25 Emerging Technology Firms. We will be ------- **139.** your company in our September issue. This is considered a great honor by our readers, as our list includes only ------- **140.** that advance the industry in significant ways.

As Voyacon's founder, could you e-mail us a digital photograph of yourself to use in the article? ------ **141.** . We would need to receive it ------- **142.** August 5. Otherwise, we will use a public-domain photo.

Thanks for your help, and congratulations.

Sincerely,

Karel Authier
Editor-in-Chief

139. (A) profile
(B) profiling
(C) profiles
(D) profiled

140. (A) publications
(B) machines
(C) techniques
(D) enterprises

141. (A) Hundreds of companies were initially considered.
(B) We will forward several copies as soon as possible.
(C) This is the fifth year we will be publishing this list.
(D) It should be a high-resolution, full-color image.

142. (A) by
(B) at
(C) within
(D) among

Questions 143-146 refer to the following memo.

To: All Employees
From: Carmen Phelps, Central City Museum Director
Re: Special Exhibitions Curator
Date: November 15

To All Staff,

Please note that an advertisement will be placed in this Wednesday's newspaper regarding a new position at the Central City Museum. After the ------- **143.** of *Bloom Outside the Box*, our recent exhibition showcasing the artwork of local sculptor Leanne Bloom, the museum board has decided to allocate a new position dedicated to creating new quarterly exhibitions. The position title is Special Exhibitions Curator. The successful applicant ------- **144.** work on January 2.

------- **145.** . Proven knowledge of local and regional artists is preferred. ------- **146.** museum staff are encouraged to apply. Please contact Liliana Wells at extension 449 with questions.

Thank you.

Carmen

143. (A) popularity
(B) winner
(C) goal
(D) awareness

144. (A) started
(B) will start
(C) has started
(D) was starting

145. (A) Board nominations close at the end of the day on Friday.
(B) Critic Tony Watanabe gave the exhibition a five-star review.
(C) The position requires extensive experience.
(D) We look forward to hosting this event.

146. (A) Expressed
(B) Observed
(C) Depended
(D) Qualified